

Ryan Pégoud

Location: Munich, Germany
Citizenship: French, German

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EDUCATION

MSc Computational Statistics and ML — UCL, London, England 09/2024 – 09/2025

Yearly average: **78.5%**, **Distinction**

Thesis title: Neural Memory Augmentation for In-Context Learning in Agentic Language Models

Supervisor: **Tim Rocktäschel** (UCL DARK, DeepMind, Recursive)

MEng in Computer Engineering — EPF, Montpellier, France 03/2019 – 07/2023

Graduated with **First-Class Honours** (*Mention Très Bien*)

- Ranked 9/149 (**top 6%**)
- MEng Average: 16.92/20 (**84.6%**)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Visiting Researcher — BMW Group, Munich, Germany 02/2026 – 08/2026

Project: Efficient Deployment of End-to-End Autonomous Driving Architectures

- Designed and implemented a **white-box knowledge distillation pipeline** for an 11B-parameter reasoning **VLA** model, including distributed data collection, training, and evaluation infrastructure.
- Developed a CKA-informed layer selection method for distillation initialisation and supervision, outperforming uniform layer selection baselines.
- Explored autoregressive-to-block-diffusion distillation as an alternative decoding paradigm for latency-constrained inference.

Data Scientist (MEng Thesis) — BMW Group, Munich, Germany 02/2023 – 07/2023

Thesis Grade: 20/20 (100%)

- Engineered a deterministic anomaly detection system based on vehicle hardware features to replace a biased, low-performing LightGBM model. Deployed the solution **at the scale of BMW's fleet** using **PySpark** and **AWS**.
- Separately, developed a NeuralProphet model for fleet connectivity forecasting, achieving **92% accuracy with a 3-day horizon**.

Data Scientist (BEng Thesis & Student Job) — CEWE 07/2021 – 07/2022

Thesis Grade: 17.7/20 (88.5%)

- **BEng Thesis (Germany, 07/2021 – 01/2022)**: Developed a multilingual **BERT** model for text classification achieving a **90% F1-score** across **14 classes** and **3 languages**. Calibrated with temperature scaling to enable meaningful uncertainty quantification.
- **Student Job (France (remote) 06/2022 – 07/2022)**: Shipped two projects: an **aspect-based sentiment analysis pipeline** with BERT and a **time series model** using NeuralProphet to forecast customer service traffic.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Lecturer & Pedagogical Tutor — EPF, Montpellier, France 09/2023 – 06/2024

- **As Lecturer (09/2023 – 01/2024)**: Designed and delivered a new **MSc-level NLP module for 30 students**, creating the curriculum from scratch and managing all lectures, assignments, and exams.
- **As Tutor (01/2024 – 06/2024)**: Mentored an MSc student through their thesis on **Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)** for helicopter certification, in partnership with *Airbus Helicopter*.

PUBLICATIONS

CONFERENCE PAPERS

1. Ryan Sullivan, **Ryan Pégoud**, Ameen Ur Rehman, Xincheng Yang, Junyun Huang, Aayush Verma, Nistha Mitra, John P Dickerson. **"Syllabus: Portable Curricula for Reinforcement Learning Agents"**, **Outstanding Paper Award** on Tooling, Environments, and Evaluation for RL. *Reinforcement Learning Conference (RLC)*, 2025, Alberta, Canada.

WORKSHOP PUBLICATIONS WITH PEER-REVIEW

1. **Ryan Pégoud**, Thibault Lahire. **Better Gradient Steps for Deep On-Policy Reinforcement Learning"**. *Aligning Reinforcement Learning Experimentalists and Theorists Workshop at the International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2024, Vienna, Austria.

ONLINE PUBLICATIONS WITH EDITORIAL REVIEW

- Authored **12 technical articles** on *Towards Data Science* and *Data Science Collective*.
- Topics: RL, NLP, JAX, Transformers, Triton, GPU programming
- My articles have accumulated over **80k+ reads** and received multiple **Editor's Picks**.

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

SYLLABUS: SYNCHRONIZED CURRICULUM LEARNING FOR RL AGENTS

- Contributed **multi-agent learning curricula** in **PyTorch** for our RLC 2025 paper.

STOIX: DISTRIBUTED SINGLE-AGENT REINFORCEMENT LEARNING IN JAX

- Contributed an implementation of **Rainbow DQN** (*Hessel et al., 2017*) to this popular **JAX**-based RL library.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, Flutter
- **ML Frameworks:** JAX, PyTorch, Triton, Transformers, Scikit-learn, LightGBM
- **Data & ML Libraries:** NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, PySpark, Hugging Face, Weights & Biases, Plotly
- **DevOps & Cloud:** Git, Docker, AWS

LANGUAGES AND HOBBIES

LANGUAGES

French: Native
English: Fluent
German: Proficient
Spanish: Conversational

HOBBIES

Music: Guitar (8 years); solo and band concert experience.
Rollerblading: Racing & freestyle (8 years); competed in FISE World.
Calisthenics: 7 years of practice.
Thai Boxing: 2 years of practice.